

Reboot The Earth UCSD FAQs

Saving the planet through innovation

Reboot the Earth is co-hosted by the United Nations including [OICT](#), [FAO](#), and [DPGA](#).



Reboot the Earth UCSD - General Information

Are you ready to Reboot the Earth at UCSD? [Register here!](#)

Dates: May 8-9, 2026

Location: [San Diego Supercomputer Center Auditorium](#)

Times:

May 8: 9am - 5:30pm

May 9: 9am - 5:30pm

UCSD Campus Wifi:

- **UCSD** wifi is available for non-institution affiliated guests. Join by selecting "UCSD-Guest" from the wifi options and then accepting the terms and conditions.
- **Eduroam** is also available for UCSD affiliated participants and other participating university affiliates.

What is Reboot the Earth?

Reboot The Earth is a social coding event that brings young computer programmers, administrators, architects, scientists and other interested people together to improve upon or build technology that addresses the current climate crisis. This location's theme focus will be on wildfire prevention and management, and will take place around the globe in the months of March to October 2026. Each location will be presented with specific UN selected challenges that focus on local climate issues.

Learn more about [Reboot the Earth](#).

What is included in the prize pack for winning teams?

- Certificates in recognition of their efforts and accomplishments.
- Additional details coming soon!

Join us at UCSD!

At Reboot the Earth UCSD, taking place **May 8-9, 2026**, the organizing partners will collaborate with students, climate experts, and the broader open-source community.

Over the course of two days, innovators will be presented with a series of tech challenges, for which they will use open data, AI, and tech concepts to build a digital public good. Each solution should aim to solve a local climate crisis unique to their community needs, and be available to others – improving or building upon open source programs that can be used by anyone globally to address the climate crisis.

Participants will benefit from dedicated support from mentors and partners, aimed at refining and enhancing their prototypes. The event will end with an award ceremony on the final day, recognizing and celebrating the achievements of the participants.

RTE Hackathon Agenda Overview

Day 1

9:00am	Attendee Check-in & Coffee/Light Refreshments
10:00am	Reboot the Earth Opening & Welcome
11:00am	Morning Working Session Begins
12:15pm	Networking Lunch
12:45pm	Afternoon Working Session Begins
2:30pm	Coffee and Snacks
5:30pm	Day 1 Concludes

Day 2

9:00am	Attendee Check-in & Coffee/Light Refreshments
9:30am	Morning Working Session Begins
12:15pm	Networking Lunch
12:45pm	Afternoon Working Session Begins
2:00pm	Project Submission Deadline; Preliminary Judging Begins
3:45pm	Finalists Announced (assumes 20 teams participating)
4:00pm	Final Round Pitches (by Preliminary Round Winners)
4:30pm	<i>Social Hour & Project Showcase (for ALL Projects!)</i>
5:30pm	Winners Announced!

Who should attend?

Reboot the Earth is committed to hosting a diverse and inclusive event. As inheritors of our planet, we especially want to involve members of the youth community. We encourage young programmers, developers, climate change advocates, and those passionate about AI to join us, especially those interested in creating technology that can help advance the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

Can I still attend if I don't know anything about writing code?

Absolutely! Bringing an idea to life takes much more than just a skilled developer, and there are so many ways to contribute to an open source project that has nothing to do with writing code. The beauty of a hack-a-thon is that we all come together to work toward the same goal. You can help define use cases and best practices or help to simplify hard-to-grasp concepts. You can share your personal and professional experiences to help craft user stories and personal criteria. You can write documentation, or even help test a new tool. Your level of coding or configuration experience is not a barrier!

Will my meals be covered?

Yes! The following will be covered:

- May 8: Light Refreshments/Coffee & Lunch (including snacks, coffee, water, tea, and soft beverages)
- May 9: Light Refreshments/Coffee & Lunch (including snacks, coffee, water, tea, and soft beverages)

Is there a way for me to attend Reboot the Earth UCSD virtually?

We are thrilled to be hosting Reboot the Earth UCSD in-person and are not planning to include a virtual participation component at this time. There will be a separate virtual Reboot the Earth engagement for those that are unable to attend an in-person event.

Will Reboot the Earth happen in any other in-person locations?

Yes! The United Nations are planning a number of other in-person Reboot the Earth hackathons from March to October 2026, including Ethiopia, Qatar, Rome, Morocco, Doha, and Kigali.

Why focus on digital public goods (DPGs)?

Digital public goods are open source software, open standards, open data, open AI systems, and open content collections that adhere to privacy and other applicable laws and best practices, do no harm, and help attain the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). DPGs not only foster innovation and collaboration but also ensure that the technologies developed are accessible, equitable, and scalable across different regions and borders. By creating DPGs, Reboot the Earth will help ensure the solutions created can be reused and adapted to meet different contextual needs.

[Learn more about what it means to be a digital public good.](#)

Rules and Principles for Reboot the Earth UCSD!

Throughout this challenge, participants will be encouraged to follow the Principles for Digital Development, which have been developed by United Nations Agencies Funds and Programs and endorsed by International Organizations worldwide. See: <https://digitalprinciples.org> for more information.

- All the inputs and outputs of this challenge must be covered by recognized open source and creative commons licensing.
- Teams can have a maximum of 5 members.
- All the Reboot the Earth Tech Challenges will be conducted in English.
- Applications should be submitted online (either individual/groups).
- The organizers do not cover the cost of travel to the Tech Challenge venues. Participants will need to cover their own cost of travel and accommodations.
- Participants **cannot recycle old projects or start developing their solution beforehand**; however, it is possible to use parts of projects they built before.
- After the two days of the Hackathon development period, a panel of judges will do a science fair style judging where the judges will then choose five winning teams to present their winning solutions to everyone.

Final Deliverables will include:

The final pitching deliverables from each team may include all or one of the following:

- The platform: including, but not limited to - Dashboard, Interface, Website, App.
- Code base: to be appropriately commented along/uploaded for code review and evaluation.
- Documentation: short presentation (7-10 slides) describing the submission (approach, methodology, etc.).
- Video: demo of your application

How You Will be Judged:

[Click here](#) to view the rubric the judges will be using to judge you on.

How can I prepare to attend?

What do I need to bring with me?

- Laptop
- Collaborative spirit
- Monitor (optional)

Learn more about digital public goods:

- [DPG Standard](#) - Learn what the requirements needed to be considered a DPG
- [DPG Registry](#) - Discover and learn about other DPGs

- [Slack](#): Slack is a messaging app that connects people to the information they need. By bringing people together to work as one unified team, Slack transforms the way organizations communicate.
 - [Learn more](#) and access tutorials
 - [Slack Open Source](#)

Learn the Basics of GitHub:

- GitHub serves as a central, open, communal home for all the bits and pieces that make up an open source project. Sure, that may include code, but it also means links to existing resources, ideas, roadmaps, documentation, diagrams, Wikis, etc.
 - [Introduction to GitHub](#)

Terms of Registration

Please note that photographs and footage will be taken throughout Reboot the Earth events. These may be used by UCSD and the United Nations host agencies (OICT, FAO, and DGPA) for marketing and publicity in our publications, on our website and in social media, or in any third party publication. By registering and attending Reboot the Earth, I grant the United Nations host agencies (OICT, FAO) and DGPA permission to use my likeness in a photograph, video, or other digital media ("photo") in any and all of its publications, including web-based publications, without payment or other consideration.

Please let a host know on the day of if you would like to be excluded from being in any photos or videos.

Have more questions?

Please feel free to contact event organizers at uniteideas@un.org
